

pursuing DevOps roles undervalue programming skills, believing it's not essential for their career path, which is a wrong notion.

Candidates need to know the underlying technologies and frameworks, and build on programming skills rather than just mastering specific tools even if they're not directly used in the current role, since they need to adapt to evolving technology landscapes and contribute to roles in DevOps positions. While tools and products may change, the focus should remain on learning the fundamentals to build a solid foundation to adapt to new tools with ease.

Q. When it comes to DevOps hiring, what role does certification play?

A. Certification in DevOps is not the primary factor for hiring managers or clients. However, this doesn't mean certifications hold no value. They may not directly help to secure a job, but can serve as a validation of one's learning and commitment. They represent the skills and knowledge acquired outside of formal education or work experience. They can be beneficial in scenarios where individuals are transitioning into new roles or fields, such as moving into DevOps from another area. For hiring managers, this means that the individual has dedicated time and effort to upskilling. For startups or mid-sized companies lacking the resources to extensively assess candidates, certifications can serve as a useful screening tool. They provide assurance that candidates possess fundamental knowledge and can quickly become productive members of the team.

However, certifications should not be viewed as a guarantee of employment. Building a strong portfolio of practical projects and demonstrating real-world experience often holds more weight in today's competitive job market.

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Q. How has the adoption of DevOps practices evolved over the past few years and where do you see this trend going?

A. DevOps practices have certainly evolved. Initially, automation was minimal or non-existent, with tasks like server setup and software testing being performed manually. However, with the rise of DevOps, organisations have transitioned from standalone automation frameworks to comprehensive DevOps ecosystems, optimising not only internal testing and validation but also providing automated tools for customers. This shift has drastically reduced manual testing and infrastructure setup, leading to faster delivery cycles and improved efficiency.

This evolution has come with its own set of challenges, particularly around ensuring backward compatibility and addressing security concerns.

However, tools and technologies have emerged to address these challenges, with open source solutions playing a significant role in enabling rollback mechanisms and enhancing security in DevOps pipelines.

Looking ahead, DevOps is likely to continue evolving at a rapid pace, driven by the need to deploy software faster and more efficiently, with the goal of shortening release cycles to minutes or even seconds. Companies are increasingly focused on further streamlining their processes, emphasising not just automation but also backward compatibility and security. Professionals need to adapt and upgrade their skills to integrate automation, security, and backward compatibility, to deliver software at breakneck speeds while maintaining reliability and security standards.

Q. How important are security, compliance and regulations for somebody in the open source ecosystem?

A. Understanding security, compliance, and regulations is important for anyone in the open source ecosystem, even if it's not their primary focus. While individuals may not need to grasp the legal intricacies of every company or product, having a basic understanding of security vulnerabilities is essential. This means being aware of potential risks when using open source tools and staying informed about any security breaches or updates.

Considerations around security become especially important when dealing with sensitive data, as demonstrated by regulations like GDPR. In today's landscape, data is at the core of nearly every aspect of technology, from DevOps to machine learning. Therefore, even a basic understanding of security principles can be invaluable. Practically, this means being mindful of best practices, such as avoiding storing access keys in public repositories or saving passwords in plain text. **END** 🐧